

Light Actors

Light Actors in Unreal Programming for games helps in creating different types of lights within the gaming universe. Unreal basically has four major types of light types which are namely Directional, Spot, Point, Rect and Sky. Directional Light is most commonly used to depict outside light like the sunlight which is coming from a source that is infinite miles away, while the Point Light is basically your bulb light which is emitting in all directions from a single source point. As far as Spotlights are concerned, these are the typical spotlights that emit light from a single point source and is restricted by cones to increase the intensity wherever it is being cast. Rect Light is emitted from a rectangular plane. Lastly, Sky Light captures the background of your scene and applies it as the background to the meshes of your particular level.



Source: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0jzoyfvrmo>

Light creation is done with the Light Actors in Unreal

Point Light

Point Light actors work in a similar way to the real-life bulbs that emit light coming from the tungsten filament into all the directions. Though, for the sake of performance, a Point Light actor in Unreal is able to emit equal light in all directions that is coming from a single point source in question. When a Point Light Actor is selected, it can be set into any of the following three settings depending on the use.

- **Static:** This simply means that the light cannot be changed during the game. It is the fastest possible method for rendering which allows for baked lighting.